

1951, September 8

The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M. Cap.

CAPUCHIN FRANCISCAN FATHERS
PAX ET BONUM
ST. FELIX FRIARY
HUNTINGTON, INDIANA
September 8th 1951

Nativity of Mary Most Holy, Virgin Mother of God

Blessed be God in all His designs.

Miss Loretta Gibson
Mercy-Hall Hospital
Detroit, Michigan

God bless you Miss Gibson, - you and yours this happy Feast of Mary's Nativity. --

Ah! the aurora of Salvation's Day. Next to Jesus Himself and always with Him may she be ever our refuge and our stay during this pilgrimage on earth, in reality so very short at the longest and still, at times so seemingly long. Indeed I say again God bless you, and May Jesus the true Light breath His own Spirit of good will and of harmonious enlightenment on each and all of those unselfishly interested in Mercy-Hall activity, - present, past, future. This has been my prayer for you and for them.

Glory be to God! What a record is not the story of that fair flower? -- a record indeed of genuine, Christian activity and of really practical Catholic Action; a record of ups and downs; a record of struggles, bordering on the desperate and of escapes hair-splittingly close to disaster: struggles with and escapes from financial difficulties and bankruptcy, from suspicion and criticism (sometimes honest and well meant), and from envy and ambitions intriguing and consequent misrepresentation and calumny, etc. -- and in a way some of all this, before the idea of Mercy Hall was fully conceived or its "Heaven-sent blueprints" unfolded and it was at once stressed: "Get started. . . . if necessary with a single patient in some old attic." --- intimating at least in effect: "God who loves tiny beginnings will know -- as He always does know best - how and when to provide developments".

"Heaven-sent blue-prints"? Indeed! For that "miraculously-developed", unfadingly blooming, little slip from the girl-friend's grave was nothing less than just that, Heaven, sent blueprint. In a way it was more; for who with a spark of supernatural faith in God, could even behold that phonimally-blooming little slip without